Like the other Kubernetes objects we have worked with so far, manifests for ConfigMaps can be applied to a cluster using the Kubernetes CLI. Open a Terminal window, navigate to your Catalog Service project (catalog-service), and run the following command:

```
$ kubectl apply -f k8s/configmap.yml
```

You can verify that the ConfigMap has been created correctly with this command:

```
$ kubectl get cm -l app=catalog-service

NAME             DATA   AGE
catalog-config   1      7s
```

The values stored in a ConfigMap can be used to configure containers running in a few different ways:

- Use a ConfigMap as a configuration data source to pass command-line arguments to the container.
- Use a ConfigMap as a configuration data source to populate environment variables for the container.
- Mount a ConfigMap as a volume in the container.

As you learned in chapter 4 and practiced since then, Spring Boot supports externalized configuration in many ways, including via command-line arguments and environment variables. Passing configuration data as command-line arguments or environment variables to containers has its drawbacks, even if it is stored in a ConfigMap. For example, whenever you add a property to a ConfigMap, you must update the Deployment manifest. When a ConfigMap is changed, the Pod is not informed about it and must be re-created to read the new configuration. Both those issues are solved by mounting ConfigMaps as volumes.